

2.1 Backup And Restore

There are two things you can do in terms of backing up the Registry: either back up the entire Registry, or export the specific key you are going to edit.

To export a Registry key, open Regedit using the Run command box. Find the key or sub-key you want to edit and select it by clicking on it. Choose **File > Export**. In the dialog box, select the location where you want to save the key, select to save it as a .reg file, and select the “Selected Branch” option. Give a name for the file and click Save. It will be saved as a .reg file.

If you want to back up the entire Registry, use the backup utility provided with XP. It is generally not recommended to export the entire Registry or a hive using the “export” method, as any changes or accidental erasures while working with .reg file may have disastrous consequences. (Please bear with our warnings—you might just be glad you did!) Open the backup software from **All Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Backup**. Select the checkbox that says “System State Data”. This will back up the registry, boot files, and the COM+ class registration database.

At any later point, you can either restore the individual key you exported using the method above, or the entire system state. Restoring the individual key is a simple double-click on the .reg file you saved.

To restore the system state, open the Backup utility, click Advanced Mode and select the Restore and Manage Media tab. Select the backed up system state file you want to restore. Check the System State box. In the “Restore Files to” box, select Original Location. In the Tools menu, select Options, and click on “Always replace the file on my computer”, then on OK. (If you don’t do this, you will be asked for a confirmation for each and every file during the restore process.) Click “Start Restore”. You will get a warning that says: “Restoring System State will always overwrite current